

PathFinder — User Manual

Introduction

Welcome to PathFinder! This manual will guide you through every feature of the platform based on your role. PathFinder supports three types of users: Students, Organizations, and Administrators.

Part 1: Student Guide

1. Registration

1. Navigate to the PathFinder homepage.
2. Click "Get Started" or "Sign Up."
3. Select "Student" as your role.
4. Enter your email address, first name, last name, and a secure password.
5. Click "Register."
6. You will be automatically logged in and redirected to your Student Dashboard.

2. Profile Setup

A complete profile is essential for accurate match scoring. Navigate to "Profile" in the sidebar.

Basic Information

- **First Name & Last Name:** Your legal name.
- **Bio:** A 1-2 sentence summary of your professional identity.
- **University:** Your current academic institution.
- **Major:** Your area of study.
- **Graduation Year:** Your expected graduation year.

Skills

- Click "Add Skill" and type a skill name (e.g., "React", "Machine Learning", "Public Speaking").
- Add at least 5 skills for optimal match scoring.
- Skills are used by the AI matching engine to calculate compatibility with opportunities.

Certifications

- Click "Add Certification" and enter the certification name, issuing organization, and date.
- Examples: "AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner — Amazon — Jan 2026"

Portfolio Links

- Add links to your GitHub, LinkedIn, personal website, or portfolio.
- These are visible to organizations reviewing your applications.

Resume Upload

- Click "Upload Resume" and select a PDF file (max 5MB).
- Your resume can be parsed by the AI to auto-fill profile fields.

Profile Picture

- Upload a professional photo for your profile.

Profile Strength

- The profile strength meter shows how complete your profile is.
- A 100% complete profile maximizes your match scores.

3. Discovering Opportunities

Dashboard Recommendations

Your Student Dashboard displays AI-recommended opportunities based on your skills and major.

Search Page

Navigate to "Search" in the sidebar to access the full search experience:

- **Keyword Search:** Type keywords to search titles and descriptions.
- **Category Filter:** Filter by Internship, Scholarship, Grant, or Hackathon.
- **Location Filter:** Filter by Remote, On-site, or specific locations.

Bookmarking

Click the bookmark icon on any opportunity to save it for later. Access saved opportunities via "Bookmarks" in the sidebar.

4. Applying for Opportunities

1. Click on an opportunity to view its full details.
2. Click "Apply Now."
3. Optionally write a cover letter (recommended for higher match scores).
4. Click "Submit Application."
5. The system will automatically calculate your match score in the background.

Important Notes

- You cannot apply to the same opportunity twice.
- You can withdraw an application at any time (except after acceptance).
- Your application status will be visible in the "My Applications" section.

5. Tracking Applications

Navigate to "Applications" in the sidebar to see all your submitted applications.

Application Statuses

Status	Meaning
PENDING	Your application has been received but not yet reviewed
REVIEWING	The organization is actively reviewing your application
SHORTLISTED	You've been selected for further consideration
ACCEPTED	Congratulations! You've been accepted
REJECTED	Unfortunately, you were not selected this time
WITHDRAWN	You chose to withdraw your application

Timeline

Each application has a timeline showing every status change with timestamps.

6. Using the AI Assistant

Navigate to "AI Assistant" in the sidebar to access document generation tools.

Available Generators

1. **SOP Generator:** Creates a Statement of Purpose tailored to a specific opportunity.
2. **Cover Letter Generator:** Generates a professional cover letter.
3. **Essay Generator:** Writes an essay on a topic of your choice.
4. **Personal Statement Generator:** Creates a comprehensive personal statement.

How to Use

1. Select the document type (tab at the top).
2. Choose the target opportunity (if applicable).
3. Optionally add additional context or special instructions.
4. Click "Generate."
5. Review the generated document.
6. Copy and customize as needed before submitting.

7. Notifications

The bell icon in the sidebar shows your unread notification count. Click it to view all notifications. You'll receive notifications when:

- Your application status changes
- An organization reviews your application

8. Support Tickets

If you encounter a bug or want to request a feature:

1. Navigate to "Support Tickets" in the sidebar.
 2. Click "New Ticket."
 3. Fill in the subject, description, type (Bug Report, Feature Request, etc.), and priority.
 4. Click "Submit."
 5. An admin will respond to your ticket. You can view responses and reply in the ticket detail view.
-

Part 2: Organization Guide

1. Registration

1. Navigate to PathFinder and click "Sign Up."
2. Select "Organization" as your role.
3. Enter your company email, company name, and password.
4. Click "Register."

2. Setting Up Your Profile

1. Navigate to "Profile" in the sidebar.
2. Fill in: Company Name, Description, Website URL, Industry.
3. Upload your company logo.
4. Click "Save."

3. Posting Opportunities

1. Navigate to "Post Opportunity" in the sidebar.
2. Fill in all fields:
 - **Title:** The opportunity name.
 - **Category:** Internship, Scholarship, Grant, or Hackathon.
 - **Description:** Detailed description of the role/opportunity.
 - **Eligibility:** Requirements (e.g., "3rd year CS students").
 - **Location:** Remote, On-site, or city name.
 - **Stipend:** Compensation details (if applicable).
 - **Duration:** Length of the opportunity.
 - **Deadline:** Application deadline.
3. Click "Publish" to make it live, or "Save as Draft" to publish later.

4. Reviewing Applicants

1. Navigate to your Organization Dashboard.
2. Click on an opportunity to see its applicants.
3. Applicants are sorted by AI Match Score (highest first).
4. For each applicant you can:
 - View their full profile (skills, certifications, bio)
 - Download their resume
 - View the AI-generated candidate summary
 - See the match score and match reason
5. Update their status: REVIEWING → SHORTLISTED → ACCEPTED or REJECTED.

Batch Actions

Select multiple applicants and update their statuses simultaneously.

5. Analytics

Your dashboard shows:

- Total number of opportunities posted
 - Total applications received
 - Application status breakdown (how many accepted, rejected, pending)
 - Recent application activity
-

Part 3: Admin Guide

1. Accessing the Admin Dashboard

Admin accounts have access to a dedicated dashboard with full platform oversight. Log in with an admin account to access it.

2. Platform Analytics

The analytics section displays:

- Total registered users (students, organizations)
- Total opportunities posted
- Total applications submitted
- Application status breakdown (pie chart data)
- Recent activity feed
- Recent user registrations

3. User Management

- Search users by email
- Filter users by role (STUDENT, ORGANIZATION, ADMIN)
- Change a user's role (e.g., promote to ADMIN)
- Delete user accounts (cannot delete your own admin account)

4. Opportunity Management

- View all opportunities across all organizations
- Search opportunities by title or organization
- Delete inappropriate or expired listings

5. Support Ticket Management

- View all support tickets across all users
- Read ticket descriptions and threaded messages
- Reply to tickets with admin responses
- Update ticket status (OPEN → IN_PROGRESS → RESOLVED → CLOSED)

6. System Health

Monitor real-time system information:

- Server uptime
- Memory usage (RSS, heap used, heap total)
- Database record counts
- Node.js version

7. Audit Log

Review a chronological log of all significant platform actions for compliance and debugging.

8. Data Export

Click "Export CSV" to download a spreadsheet of all application data for external analysis.
